

Shreyas Iyer

Shreyas was India's leading run-scorer in the Champions Trophy, amassing 243 runs in five innings, including two fifties.

His finest knock, 79 off 98 balls, came against New Zealand in the group stage, rescuing India from a top-order collapse. He also notched a half-century against Pakistan.

As a middle-order anchor, Shreyas navigated spin on Dubai's sluggish pitches, facing 233 deliveries — the most by any batter — and averaging over 56. His false shot percentage (6.8%) was bettered only by Shubman Gill and Joe Root among those facing 100+ balls of spin.

Balancing caution with intent, he maintained a strike rate above 72 despite a dot-ball rate of 53% (third highest). His 64 runs in boundaries against spin were the most by any batter.



6.8%

False shot percentage, third-best among 100+ ball players against spin



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Times unbeaten, excelling as a finisher

K. L. Rahul

Rahul once again adapted to India's needs, shifting down the order to accommodate Axar Patel at No. 5.

Before the Champions Trophy, Rahul had batted at No. 6 just four times, scoring 54 runs at an average of 18. In Dubai, he embraced the role, scoring 140 runs in four innings while remaining unbeaten thrice.

"Whatever the team requires, you have to accept it and find a way to perform," Rahul said after the final.

He excelled as a finisher, guiding India to victory in both knockout games. His unbeaten 42 off 34 balls helped chase down 265 against Australia, while a steady 34 off 33 ensured India crossed the line against New Zealand in the final.